

INNOVATION IN ACADEMIA

A faculty transformation lab for stronger patents, funded research and industry relevance

⚡ **VALUE PROMISE:** Research novelty • Patent potential • Fundable partnerships

01

PROGRAM



AUDIENCE

Teachers & academic leaders



DURATION

1 day | 9:30-17:00



FORMAT

Hands-on studio



INVESTMENT

INR 3,500 / person

■ Why this matters now

FOR ACADEMIC LEADERS

Turn faculty expertise into a visible pipeline of novel research, defensible IP and fundable partnerships.

WHY STUDENTS NEED IT

Research scholars learn to identify consequential problems, build inventive confidence and see how research becomes IP and real-world impact.

WHY ACADEMICIANS NEED IT

Faculty move beyond incremental publication, strengthen novelty and create credible paths to patents, funded research and industry partnerships.

■ What we will explore

- Build an inventive mindset for research, teaching and institutional challenges.
- Separate genuine novelty from routine extensions of existing work.
- Use structured frameworks to connect evidence, IP and stakeholder value.

■ What participants gain

- **Find novelty:** identify innovative, relevant problems worth solving.
- **Escape the publication trap:** move from incremental papers to defensible contribution.
- **Create IP:** shape novel, non-obvious and patent-ready concepts.
- **Attract support:** build credible industry and government-funding pathways.

INSTITUTIONAL RETURN

A stronger pipeline of patentable research, fundable proposals and industry-facing faculty initiatives.

From novelty to evidence, IP and partnership

A clear one-day journey, followed by reusable tools and a practical continuation path.

■ One-day learning journey

09:30-10:15	Beyond the next paper	Recognise the iterative publication trap and define meaningful impact.
10:15-11:15	Novel problem discovery	Scan tensions, unmet needs, anomalies and emerging opportunity landscapes.
11:30-12:45	Storytelling for relevance	Connect evidence, beneficiaries, urgency and a compelling research question.
13:45-15:00	Framework lab	Use TRIZ contradictions, inventive principles and structured idea generation.
15:15-16:15	Reverse brainstorming and IP lens	Expose failure modes and test novelty and non-obviousness.
16:15-17:00	Impact pathway	Map experiments, patent steps, industry partners and suitable funding routes.

■ Who should attend

- University and college teachers
- Heads of department and deans
- Research supervisors and lab leaders
- Curriculum, accreditation and faculty-development teams

■ Methods & tools

- Novel problem and opportunity landscapes
- Research storytelling for relevance
- TRIZ contradictions and principles
- Reverse brainstorming
- Publication-to-patent decision lens
- Industry collaboration and funding canvas

■ Takeaway toolkit

- A portfolio of consequential, underexplored research problems
- A novelty and non-obviousness canvas for a selected idea
- Concepts generated using TRIZ and reverse brainstorming
- A 30-day experiment, IP and stakeholder-engagement roadmap

■ Investment & included value

INR 3,500 per participant

Workbook, innovation tool cards, IP lens, funding canvas and participation certificate included. Institutional cohort pricing available for 25-40 participants.

Indicative fee; taxes, travel and venue costs are additional where applicable.

Three pillars of innovation

An idea becomes strategically interesting when it is **unique**, **hard to do** and **value adding** at the same time. The programs build student capability across all three.

01 UNIQUENESS

Meaningfully different

Students learn to ask whether the problem, insight or solution is genuinely different from what already exists - not merely a new implementation of a familiar idea.

SKILLS BUILT

Problem discovery, reframing, prior-art awareness, assumption breaking, divergent thinking and TRIZ.

02 HARD TO DO

Technically defensible

Innovation needs technical or execution depth. Students learn to work with constraints, contradictions, evidence and experiments so the idea is more than a superficial concept. **SKILLS**

BUILT

Systems thinking, technical trade-offs, experimentation, prototyping, non-obviousness and execution discipline.

03 VALUE ADDING

Creates real value

A clever idea is not automatically valuable. Students learn to connect innovation to a real user, institution, industry or societal need and define the change it should create. **SKILLS**

BUILT

Stakeholder insight, outcome framing, evidence, adoption thinking, value articulation and storytelling.

■ Why all three have to come together

Unique + valuable, but easy to copy

Interesting, but difficult to defend or sustain.

Unique + hard, but low value

Technically impressive, but unlikely to matter outside the project.

Hard + valuable, but not unique

Useful engineering, but limited differentiation or innovation claim.

Unique + hard + value adding

A stronger foundation for defensible innovation and meaningful impact.

■ How I help students build the three muscles

DISCOVER

Find tensions, unmet needs and consequential problems.

CHALLENGE

Question assumptions and seek a genuinely different angle.

BUILD

Work through constraints, contradictions and technical depth.

VALIDATE

Test evidence, stakeholder value, utility and feasibility.

COMMUNICATE

Turn the work into a research, patent or industry story.

THE CORE HABIT

Do not ask only, "Can we build it?" Ask: "Is it different? Is it difficult enough to be defensible? Does it create enough value to matter?"

What the three pillars are designed to enable

The objective is not idea generation for its own sake. Students learn to convert differentiated, substantive and useful ideas into stronger research, invention and industry-facing evidence.

■ Outcome 01 - Impactful research

UNIQUENESS

A consequential question, clearer research gap and a contribution that is meaningfully different.

HARD TO DO

Technical depth, rigorous methods, experiments, difficult trade-offs and credible evidence.

VALUE ADDING

A problem that matters to a field, stakeholder, industry, society or future system.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Problem landscape • novelty map • research question • experiment plan • contribution statement • publication pathway.

■ Outcome 02 - Patents and defensible IP

UNIQUENESS

Prior-art awareness and a clearly differentiated mechanism, method or system element.

HARD TO DO

Non-obvious technical substance, constraints and implementation depth that make the idea defensible.

VALUE ADDING

Utility, adoption potential and a reason the invention should exist beyond novelty alone.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Invention canvas • prior-art search terms • novelty hypothesis • non-obviousness rationale • prototype or evidence plan.

■ Outcome 03 - Industry-ready innovators

UNIQUENESS

Spot opportunities others miss and frame a differentiated response rather than repeating obvious solutions.

HARD TO DO

Move from idea to execution: handle constraints, collaborate, experiment, learn and improve.

VALUE ADDING

Connect technical work to business, user and societal outcomes and explain why it matters.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Problem brief • prototype or concept • decision rationale • outcome story • pitch • 30/60-day action plan.

WHAT ACADEMIC LEADERS CAN REVIEW AFTER A COHORT

Problem portfolio • research directions • possible IP candidates • experiment plans • industry-facing pitches • participant capability evidence • recommended next steps.

The program builds capability and stronger pathways. Publication, patent and hiring outcomes are not guaranteed and depend on the quality of subsequent work, evidence, review and execution.